

Augustin Godinot

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About me

With 4 years of experience bridging academic research and government regulation, I design robust methodologies to audit black-box models and detect platform manipulations. Seeking to leverage my technical expertise to improve our online ecosystems and mitigate systemic algorithmic risks stemming from VLOPs/VLOSEs.

Technical skills

Algorithmic auditing

- VLOPs Systemic Risks
- Web scraping
- AI Regulation
- User simulation

Data & ML

- Python
- PyTorch/JAX
- Scikit-Learn
- Polars/Pandas/SQL
- Matplotlib/Altair

Mathematical Modeling

- Probability Theory
- Statistics
- Optimization
- Hypothesis Testing

Software & Infrastructure

- Latex/Typst
- Git
- Slurm
- Rust

Languages

- French, native
- English, fluent (C2 Certification)
- German, fair command (B1 Level)

Interests

- Fencing
Competitive practice, official referee
- Off the grid
cycletouring, hiking, camping
- La rustine (co-president)
community bike repair shop

Experience

- PhD Student Researcher @ INRIA/PEReN 2022 — 2026
Understanding the fundamental limits to black-box auditing and designing robust algorithms to achieve these limits.
 - Modeled auditing under manipulations, exposed impossibility results and their impacts for regulators, proposed new robust protocols.
 - Published and presented my work at international ML conferences (SaTML, AAAI, ICML) and workshops (TAIG), open-sourced reproducible code, built and organized a reading group on AI audits.
 - Collaborated with French state experts (PEReN) to reconcile the DSA/DMA/AI act transparency objectives with regulators' practical black-box constraints.

- Research Visitor @ University of Toronto March — August 2025
Visiting Nicolas Papernot's group, worked on de-incentivizing manipulations by large model providers through system oversight.

- Research Intern @ NaverLabs Europe April — October 2022
Content diversity in Search and Recommendation (news, ads, ...) Systems.
 - Trained Large Language Models for information retrieval on large-scale GPU platforms.
 - Derived tools from Information Theory and Optimization to understand the emergence and optimization of diversity in Search and Recommendation systems.

- Research Intern @ Nokia Bell Labs February — August 2021
Developed a stochastic model and algorithms for Multi-Agent Path Finding under uncertainty. Implemented for an industrial robots system in Go.

- Research Intern @ ISP, ENS Paris-Saclay Sept 2020 — Feb 2021
Simulated user interactions with music Recommender Systems, applying graph-theoretic tools to evaluate recommendation diversity and bias.

Achievements

- SaTML conference (2024):
Travel support award
- Hi!Paris Summer school (2024):
Best poster award runner-up
- Segment me if you can! (2022):
Identification of a deployed model, 2nd place awarded by the French Minister
- ENS scholarship (2018):
4 years selective government scholarship

Education

- 2026 Université de Rennes, PhD Computer Science
Thinking Out of the (Black)-Box: Tools for machine learning audits in the presence of deceptive model providers.
- 2022 ENS Paris-Saclay, MSc Advanced Wireless Communication Systems MSc & ENS AI Track
Relevant courses: Machine Learning, Optimization, Optimal Transport, Signal Processing, Information Theory, System Control, Reinforcement Learning
Activities: Wood-working club (Co-President), Math Oral Examiner (Khôlleur).
- 2018 Classes Préparatoires PCSI Lycée Pasteur, PSI* Lycée Hoche